

of 266 MHz memory, and a 2048 x 1536 UXGA display. Must be some nerds, eh?

We started seeing more conventional laptops in the 2000s after that. Let it be known that the laptop space truly saw some significant changes during this period. None of what followed in the years close to this led to a paradigm shift, as it was mostly just a better version that came out with few, yet worthy upgrades.



Credit: Alienware

There were some exceptions though. The MacBook lineup got its start in 2006. We also saw the first Chromebook, the CR-48 in 2010 when it was handed out to developers and beta testers as part of the Google Chrome pilot program. Both MacBooks and Chromebooks serve a huge chunk of consumers as reliable machines for day-to-day workloads.

Similarly, we also saw the rise of different form-factors like 2-in-1 convertibles, new and powerful iterations of processors, GPU, etc. I can't possibly list all the changes that took place during the course of the following years, but it was simply remarkable, to say the least.

KEY CHANGES - WHERE IT MATTERS THE MOST

For starters, we have more cores for action now. We have certainly come a long way from using Core 2 Duo chips back in the day to up to 11<sup>th</sup> Gen Intel Core processors with up to 8 cores fuming through your intense workloads. The results can keenly be observed across various scenarios. For instance, not only can you play even the most modern titles on laptops now, but you can also stream it online for others to watch and build a community.

The innovation in thermal space has also paved the way for slimmer and thinner laptops on the market.

Besides some of the obvious changes in the power and efficiency department, the connectivity chops of laptops have also improved by leaps and bounds. In addition to the burst of 'Always Connected' laptops and Wi-Fi 6 standards entering the scene now, the Thunderbolt port has also evolved a lot.

Not only does the new standard offer massive data transfer speeds, but you can also send in video signals and power down the same cable. Heck, you can even connect an external GPU to supercharge your laptop for gaming and 3D workloads.

Laptops don't get enough credits for shaping our lives in more ways than one. They have made it easier for us to connect with people, giving a boost to social media platforms in a way. They've been a key tool for developers and people working on-the-go. There's nothing more satisfying than being able to work outside the four walls of your room, and laptops have surely enabled that.



Credit: Intel

It's also hard not to acknowledge the fact that laptops have been a key tool for the online-first world that we are turning towards. With the COVID-19 pandemic crippling most people's lives, laptops have enabled a lot of people to do what they do best. And that being said, I can't wait to see how laptops will evolve over the next couple of years and the kind of innovations we can expect from OEMs.

THE WAY FORWARD - EVOLUTION

Laptops have always been a different kind of beast, and they still

are. Even though we have seen some pivotal moments in the history of laptop development, there's still a lot left to be desired. Why, you ask? Well, that's because the technology that was once considered to be revolutionary is now slapped with the 'mainstream' tag. Take Apple's MacBook Air, for instance.

Yes, Apple's "Envelope" ad still gives me chills to date, but there's no denying that MacBook Air is now, well, just another 'slim' laptop. In a similar fashion, I am hoping for some radical changes over the next couple of decades. And radical changes not just in terms of the form-factor, I am hoping to see innovation in some key areas that will ensure that laptops are indeed ready for world domination.

All-day battery life?

Yes, laptop manufacturers have promised all day before and they still do, but let me ask you this - Have you ever felt comfortable leaving home without the laptop charger? Not me. The only exception, in this case, would be the new MacBooks powered by the M1 chip. That's the push that other OEMs needed as they will now try to beat Apple in its own game. There's only one winner when 2 or more OEMs battle it out for the superior spot. It's us, the consumers.

5G

Cellular connectivity on laptops is still an afterthought. I say that because I am yet to have seen somebody who actively uses it even though it's readily available on a lot of laptops. Will 5G let that genie out of the bottle? Maybe not, but there are some obvious benefits that we can't turn a blind eye to. For instance, if 5G paves way for immediate access to my cloud storage with the promised faster connectivity speeds, then I would probably be fine with laptops having less built-in storage. And then there are other things like gaming with budding cloud gaming services with the help of 5G on-the-go.

Repairable laptops, anyone?

One of the main reasons why a huge chunk of people prefer investing in a